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Truecaller's call-recording feature won't work on iPhones from September 30

Truecaller is discontinuing its call-recording function on iOS — just over two years after the feature was launched — as the Swedish company opts to focus on its core offering: fighting spam calls.

On Friday, the company confirmed to TechCrunch that its call-recording feature will no longer be available on iPhones starting September 30. Users with saved call recordings can either download them to their devices, share them via email or messaging apps, or switch their storage preference to iCloud to keep the recordings accessible even after the feature is discontinued.

IMAGE CREDITS:
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Truecaller's head of iOS, Nakul Kabra, told TechCrunch the company took the decision because it wanted to focus on its Live Caller ID and automatic spam-blocking features.

In June 2023, Truecaller launched call recording on iOS for its paying subscribers, alongside reintroducing the feature on Android. The app also got support for transcribing calls natively. Both call recording and transcription were launched in India last year.

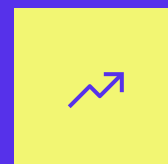
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While call recording works seamlessly on Android, it is more complicated on iOS, where Apple's operating system does not let third-party apps record calls natively. To work around this, Truecaller uses a recording line that merges calls to record — a method that increases both costs and complexity, per Kabra. These challenges ultimately led to the feature being discontinued.

The company has [set up a support page](#) to help users if they face any issues during the transition.

Truecaller's move comes months after Apple introduced native call recording and transcription support for iPhone users in an [iOS 18.1 update](#) last year. The native feature does not require users to connect to a record line to record the call, unlike Truecaller, and also brings Apple Intelligence-powered transcriptions.

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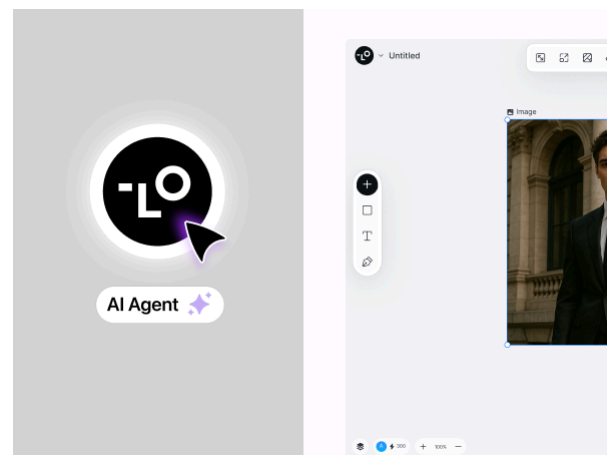
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That said, Truecaller had introduced call recording in the first place to entice iPhone users to upgrade, as the caller ID function is limited on the free tier.

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Paying users also get [real-time caller ID](#), along with advanced and automatic spam blocking, Siri shortcuts, incognito mode, and other features.

Truecaller has around 3 million subscribers worldwide, but iOS accounts for 44% of its total premium revenue, per its [second-quarter financial results](#) (PDF).

Topics: [Apps](#) [call recording](#) [India](#) [iPhone](#)

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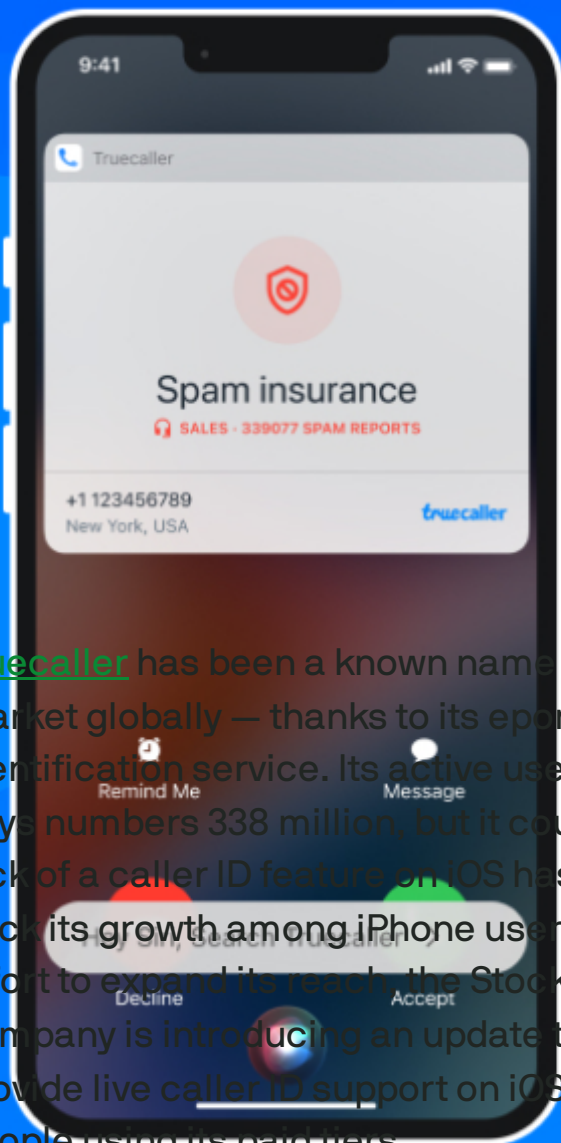
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Truecaller brings live caller ID to iPhone... but

with a catch



Jagmeet Singh — 3:30 AM PDT · April 12, 2023

[Truecaller](#) has been a known name in the app market globally — thanks to its eponymous caller-identification service. Its active user base these days numbers 338 million, but it could be bigger: A lack of a caller ID feature on iOS has arguably held back its growth among iPhone users. Now, in an effort to expand its reach, the Stockholm-based company is introducing an update that will finally provide live caller ID support on iOS, available to people using its paid tiers.

IMAGE CREDITS: TRUECALLER

The new feature comes as Truecaller continues to see a lot of growth, but also some knocks in its strongest markets. The app has been one of the more popular ones among mobile users in markets like India where [spammers target the masses](#). Yet the company has faced criticism over how it collects data for its caller ID service.

Last year, an investigation by Indian magazine The Caravan [claimed](#) that Truecaller was “comprised of details which have been collected without consent.” However, the company [denied the allegations](#) and asserted that the investigation was flawed and based on inaccurate information.

The new caller ID feature will be offered only to users who are on the app’s premium tiers (priced at a range of tiers ranging from \$0.99 per month per

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individual, through to \$4.99/month when a user's carrier is not supported and \$9.99/month for family plans, with discounts on annual subscriptions).

And it won't be just like it is on Android: Unlike the seamless experience available on that platform — users see a caller ID instantly when they receive an incoming call — the iPhone experience will involve a step that requires interacting with Siri.

Nakul Kabra, product director for iOS at Truecaller, told TechCrunch that the app has had a limited experience on the iPhone due to how Apple works with third-party caller ID apps.

The current framework for identifying calls in Truecaller is limited to a finite set of numbers stored in directories in Apple's CallKit framework, chosen by Truecaller's spam algorithm. That means that other numbers not stored locally require manual search, he said.

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access live caller ID support by saying, “Hey Siri, Search Truecaller.” This will allow Siri to capture the number appearing on the screen, search for it on the app, then show the result to the user.

The feature leverages Apple’s Siri Shortcuts and App Intents to offer the anticipated live caller ID experience.

That means users will need first to enable the Search Truecaller shortcut on their iPhone by tapping the *Add to Siri* option in the Premium tab. The first time the shortcut runs, the user will be prompted to allow Truecaller to search from the screenshots the shortcut captures.

“We have been tinkering around with App Intents for the last few months since iOS 16 was publicly launched... Previous iterations didn’t have the right experience to be used in the context of a live call. One of the more recent iterations is what has evolved into this feature,” Kabra said.

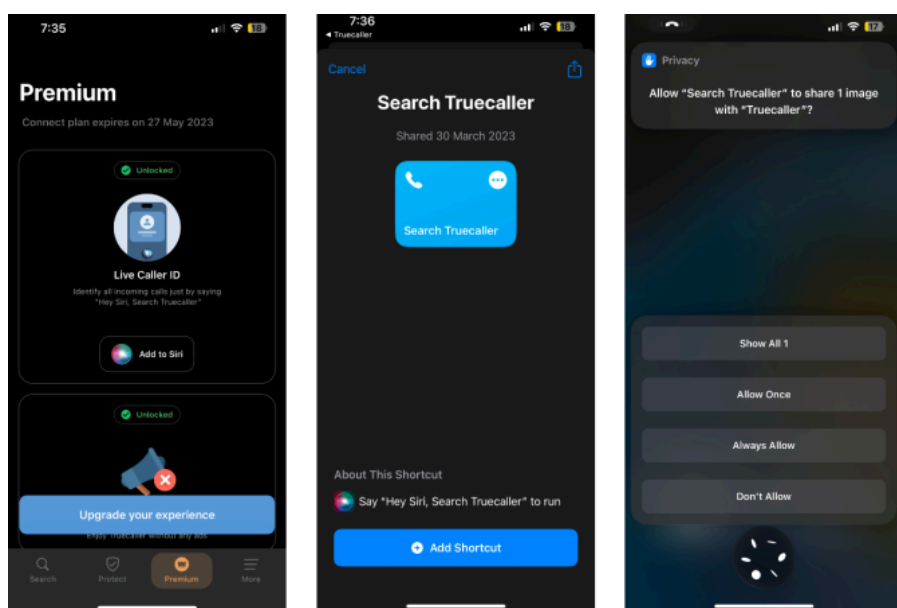


IMAGE CREDITS: JAGMEET SINGH / TECHCRUNCH

Users with more recent iPhones, including the iPhone 14 Pro and iPhone 14 Pro Max, will have the option to access the feature without having to call out the Siri phrase and instead will be able to tap

the back of their handset. For this, they need to enable the Search Truecaller shortcut from the [Back Tap](#) gesture settings.

With this update, Truecaller has also doubled its CallKit directory size and improved its spam detection algorithm to ensure that spam, scam, and fraud calls are recognized more accurately.

“This improved directory makes sure that most top spam and verified business calls can be identified right away even without needing to ask Siri.

However, given the limitations of the platform, we cannot identify all calls using the traditional call directories mechanism. This is where the new Live Caller ID comes in and makes sure that you can identify every single call,” Kabra said.

The company also says premium users’ spam lists will receive daily updates. Meanwhile, free users only have the option to update the list manually.

Truecaller additionally introduced a commenting feature for iPhone users that lets them read user feedback coming on spam calls and even contribute with their own comments. This feature was previously available on Android.

SMS filtering on iOS is also being improved with the ability to categorize incoming text messages into Finance, Orders, Reminders, Coupons, Offers and Junk categories. This categorization is currently live in India, South Africa and Nigeria and will soon be rolled out to other markets.

The new set of features on Truecaller for iPhone comes months after the iOS app received a [revamped experience](#) in August last year. Since then, the company said its daily users on the iPhone had grown more than 80%. The company declined to provide details on how many users it has on iOS in total.

“Live Caller ID on iPhone is the one major aspect that has eluded our iPhone app, and we are excited to finally introduce it with the help of Siri,” said Alan Mamedi, co-founder and CEO at Truecaller, in a prepared statement.

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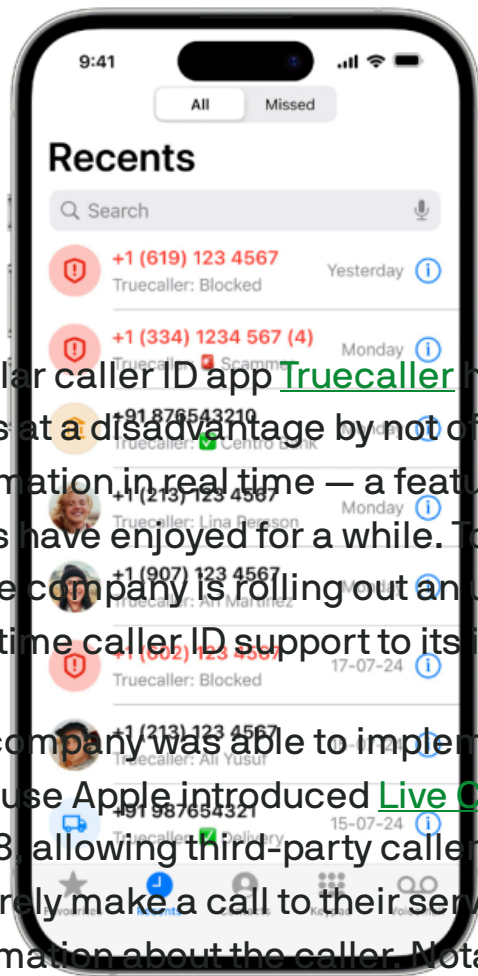
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Truecaller brings real-time caller ID to iPhone users



Popular caller ID app [Truecaller](#) has long left iPhone users at a disadvantage by not offering the caller information in real time — a feature its Android users have enjoyed for a while. Today that changes as the company is rolling out an update that brings real-time caller ID support to its iOS subscribers.

The company was able to implement the feature because Apple introduced [Live Caller ID Lookup](#) in iOS 18, allowing third-party caller ID apps to securely make a call to their server to get information about the caller. Notably, this is also the first major release from the Swedish company after the co-founders Alan Mamedi and Nami Zarringhalam [stepped down from the day-to-day operations](#) in November 2024.

IMAGE CREDITS: TRUECALLER

Today, Truecaller has more than 2.6 million paying subscribers, of which only around 750,000 of them are on iOS. However, 40% of Truecaller's Premium revenue is from iOS subscriptions. The company also gets a 5x conversation rate to its premium tier on iOS compared to Android as well as 80% higher revenue from an iPhone subscriber.

Considering the importance of the iPhone to Truecaller's bottom line, the company continues to develop its iOS app.

In 2022, Truecaller [relaunched](#) the iOS app to focus on better spam detection, thanks to Apple allowing the app to store a larger set of numbers locally.

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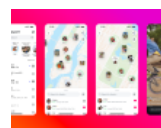
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“It did improve the overall call identification. But that wasn’t enough because in countries like India, there is a huge calling activity, and not all this would be available in the offline database,” Truecaller product director Nakul Kabra told TechCrunch in an interview.

India presents other challenges for the company as well, including the arrival of a service, [Calling Name Presentation \(commonly called CNAP\)](#), designed to curb spam. The service, currently being rolled out by local telcos, could eventually emerge as a competitor to Truecaller.



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Truecaller also updated its iOS app in 2023 with a live caller ID experience, but that involved a step requiring [interaction](#) with Siri and also wasn’t real time.

Until iOS 18’s release, Truecaller had to rely on a locally saved dictionary of limited phone numbers on iOS.

To enable the new feature, Truecaller built a new server architecture and created a separate, encrypted database for iOS, alongside its existing larger database for Android users. Apple's phone app makes encrypted requests to this database and gets encrypted responses that are only decrypted on the client (iPhone) to show the caller ID in real time. This process is called "homomorphic encryption," as the computations use encrypted data instead of decrypting them first, while decryption happens on the client to display caller information if it matches with the data stored on the server.

Kabra told TechCrunch that Truecaller had built a way to sync two databases to keep the data synced between them.

"At the moment, there might be a bit of a delay because these requests get queued up, and the encryption that we do is very time-consuming — and very expensive. ... But it should not be more than a few hours," he said.

TechCrunch tested live caller ID under Truecaller's beta program last week and noticed that the feature does provide caller information in real time in most cases, though it sometimes misses.

Truecaller's premium tier on iOS starts at \$9.99 a month, per individual, or \$74.99/year. The company also offers its family plan on iOS starting at \$14.99/month or \$99.99/year and the top-end Gold subscription at \$249 a year.

Users can enable the Live Caller ID Lookup feature through iPhone Settings > Apps > Phone > Call Blocking & Identification.

On iOS 18, Truecaller also updated its interface with the caller's name appearing in bold over their

number. Now Truecaller is working on support for images to show up in the caller ID for its iOS users.

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